Tungsten Supply Security

Policy, financing and industrial execution across China, the EU, the UK and Japan

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Research cutoff: 3 November 2026

Candidate reissue · original research unchanged

COMPARATIVE JUDGMENT

Four policy mechanisms produce different evidence of progress

Selected cases; legal measures, public capital and industrial delivery are assessed separately

CHINA	**EXPORT LICENSING**	Item-specific permission governs qualifying tungsten products and technology.
EUROPEAN UNION	**STRATEGIC PROJECT STATUS**	El Moto under construction; a separate APT plant at proposal stage.
UNITED KINGDOM	**EQUITY + LOAN**	NWF core financing combines £36m equity and £25m lending.
JAPAN	**GRANT DECISIONS**	Equipment and conversion awards support powder and recycled feedstock.

The comparison tracks legal decisions, financial status and physical implementation in the units and scope of each source.

Research and source register

The £71m NWF headline includes £10m of contingent lending

Tungsten West / Hemerdon; announced August 2026; source amounts in GBP



£25m

Core loan fully drawn by 2 September 2026, according to FY2026 accounts

£10m

Additional accordion remained conditional in the announced package

Headline capacity, equity issuance and loan drawdown represent different financing statuses; the core loan also creates repayment exposure.

NWF announcement | Issuer financing terms | Investor accounts

Processing activity preceded the August public financing announcement

Public chronology establishes sequencing; transaction-level data is needed to assess additional output

JUL 2026

Processing and phased commissioning reported

Company operational disclosure

25 AUG

NWF investment announced

Up to £71m, including contingent capacity

BY 2 SEP

Core loan reported fully drawn

By accounts-approval date; transfer date unknown

SEP 2026

Eight-year offtake announced

Deliveries and product acceptance remain to be tested

The September offtake adds a contractual conversion route; measurable commercial supply requires reported deliveries and processing performance.

Tungsten West investor disclosures

Strategic Project status covers very different project stages

Two selected tungsten-linked projects; designation is an administrative status

EL MOTO

Construction reported

Tungsten and gold extraction at Abenójar

Developer target: first production in Q1 2029

Developer construction release

EU APT TUNGSTEN PLANT

Proposed / FID pending

Separate tungsten conversion proposal

Technical partnerships and final investment decision remain outstanding

Developer project disclosure

CRMA permit-processing timelines operate under legal triggers and exceptions. They are distinct from construction, financing or production schedules.

Grant decisions target downstream conversion and recycled feedstock

JOGMEC decisions and recipient capacity targets; announced amounts shown in JPY



ALLIED MATERIAL
Planned tungsten powder and carbide equipment; approximately 1.5× existing capacity; H1 FY2028 target.
Recipient investment: ~¥15.9bn

JAPAN NEW METALS
Target 2,400 tonnes annual APT capacity (WO_3-equivalent); April 2029 schedule.
Recipient investment: ~¥8bn

Grant decisions establish award milestones; payment and installed capacity require separate evidence.

JOGMEC decisions Allied Material Mitsubishi Materials

The February 2025 tungsten control operates at item level

MOFCOM/GACC Announcement No. 10 · effective 4 February 2025

CHEMICAL FORMS	Specified APT and tungsten oxides
POWDERS + CARBIDES	Product forms meeting stated definitions
SOLID FORMS	Listed tungsten metal and alloy forms
RELATED TECHNOLOGY	Associated production technology within control scope

The next implementation evidence is transaction-specific: licensing applications, decisions, processing times, enforcement and shipments.

Original Chinese announcement

DECISION SYNTHESIS

Evidence quality improves when financial and physical milestones are tracked separately

Selected diligence priorities for lenders, industrial buyers and policymakers

MECHANISM	EVIDENCE TO REQUEST	DECISION VARIABLE
UK financing	Loan drawdown, maturity terms, expenditure	Liquidity and ramp-up resilience
EU designation	Permits, FID, construction schedule	Actual time to productive capacity
Japan conversion grants	Payments, installed equipment, saleable output	Available conversion volumes
China licensing	Item-specific approvals and shipments	Deliverability and compliance

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